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DATA ANNOTATION

Onboarding — Welcome!

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How to Navigate the Platform

The platform is organized into three main sections that you can access from the top of the page:

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Page Overview

- "**Work on projects**" is where you'll find all of the projects and tasks available for you to work on, and where you can report time.
- "**Transfer funds**" is where you will find a summary of your earnings and a list of your recent task submissions.
- "**Inbox**" is where you'll find announcements and updates regarding projects.
- Lastly, in the top-right corner of the page, you should see your name and a drop-down arrow. Here, you can change your "Profile" details (described below), contact Support, view our Code of Conduct and FAQs, and log out of your account.

"Work on projects" Page

This is the main page of the platform where you can find active projects to work on, take qualification tests to gain access to more projects, and report time for projects that are paid per hour.

Qualifications

Qualifications are used to assess your fit for full-scope projects on the platform. They are usually miniature versions (~5-10 tasks) of the full project they are testing for. If you perform well on the qualification and demonstrate a strong understanding of the task, you will be approved to work on the full project, which often gives you access to work on hundreds or thousands of tasks. Please complete all the qualification tasks that are available to you if you would like to become qualified for a larger project.

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[QUALIFICATION] General: Taking Screenshots	$0.50	1	Feb 9
[QUALIFICATION] General Guidelines [Required]		1	Aug 30
[QUALIFICATION] [US Workers Only] Background Checks - *Complete to Unlock Additional Projects*		1	Jul 4

Showing 10 per page « ‹ 1 ›

Projects

This is the main section where you can see all of the projects available to you to work on. Whenever a new project that you are qualified for gets launched it will automatically show up in this table. The name of the project usually gives you a general sense of the type of work you'll be doing.

By default, you will receive an email at the address associated with your account whenever a new project becomes available to you. You can disable these notifications on your "Profile" page, though we recommend keeping them enabled.

We encourage you to keep a close eye on the "Projects" board as things can change quickly, and since we cannot guarantee how long a project will be available on the platform, we recommend you act quickly if you see something you are particularly interested in working on.

Pay

Projects on the platform can either be paid per task or per hour, which is indicated in the "Pay" column — per-task projects will show a flat dollar number, while hourly projects show a $/hr rate. For example, in the image below, the "Fluency Eval" project pays $0.48 for each task completed, while the "Chatbot Personalities: Entertainment+Productivity" project pays $25/hour. Per-task projects pay out automatically, but you will need to log your time for hourly projects (described under "Report Time" below).

Please note that you are allowed to work on **only one hourly project at a time**, and you may NOT have multiple tasks open or report time for tasks done simultaneously. Once you've submitted the task or tasks you were working on for your current hourly project, you're welcome to begin working on a different one — just be sure to track and submit your time separately for each project. You don't need to

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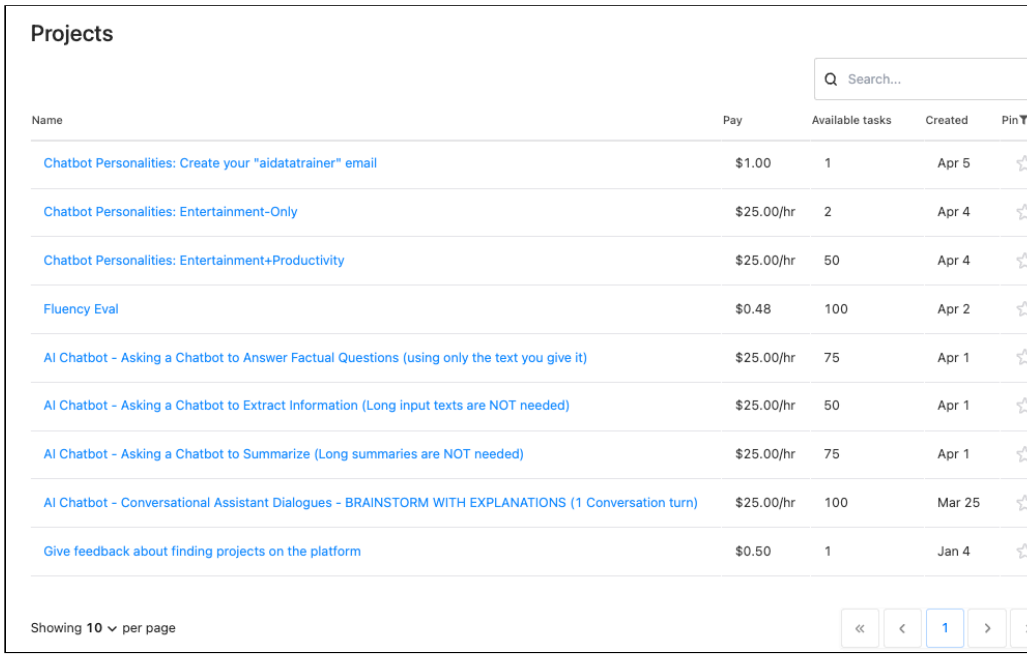
same time, so the number of available tasks may decrease as others work on the project. Alternatively, task counts can increase if tasks get added to a project, or a very similar project may get launched with a fresh batch of tasks.



Projects

Search...

Name	Pay	Available tasks	Created	Pin
Chatbot Personalities: Create your "aidatatrainer" email	$1.00	1	Apr 5	
Chatbot Personalities: Entertainment-Only	$25.00/hr	2	Apr 4	
Chatbot Personalities: Entertainment+Productivity	$25.00/hr	50	Apr 4	
Fluency Eval	$0.48	100	Apr 2	
AI Chatbot - Asking a Chatbot to Answer Factual Questions (using only the text you give it)	$25.00/hr	75	Apr 1	
AI Chatbot - Asking a Chatbot to Extract Information (Long input texts are NOT needed)	$25.00/hr	50	Apr 1	
AI Chatbot - Asking a Chatbot to Summarize (Long summaries are NOT needed)	$25.00/hr	75	Apr 1	
AI Chatbot - Conversational Assistant Dialogues - BRAINSTORM WITH EXPLANATIONS (1 Conversation turn)	$25.00/hr	100	Mar 25	
Give feedback about finding projects on the platform	$0.50	1	Jan 4	

Showing 10 per page

« ‹ 1 ›

Report Time

After you submit one or more tasks in an hourly project, an entry for that project will appear in the “Report Time” section at the bottom of the ‘Work on Projects’ page. To report your time, click on the appropriate project, enter the number of minutes you worked on the project, and click submit. You’re welcome to record your time for each task separately or in larger combined entries. **If you work on the same project again, you will use the same link as before to report additional time.** The approval period for the reported time is one week.

Note that projects will only be available in the “Report Time” section for 1 day (24 hours) after your latest completed task, so be sure to report your time promptly **after each work session**. If you have not worked on any hourly projects in the past 24 hours, this section may not be visible on your page.

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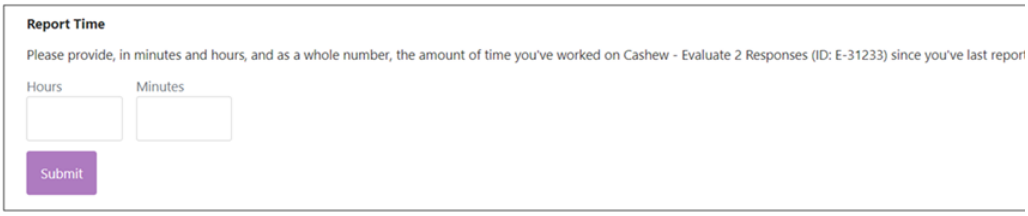
The image below is the screen that appears after you click on a project and where you enter your time worked.



“Transfer Funds” Page

Summary

At the top of the page, you will find a **summary** of your earnings.

- Withdrawable Amount: funds in your account that are available for withdrawal to your PayPal account
    - We can only pay out via PayPal, so you must either provide your PayPal email (described below) or create an account if you do not have one already. It does not need to be the same email you use to log into DataAnnotation
        - We recommend logging into your PayPal account to make sure you know the right email before adding it to your DataAnnotation Profile page
        - DOUBLE (OR TRIPLE!) CHECK THAT YOU'VE ENTERED THE CORRECT PAYPAL EMAIL — we have no recourse to recover funds sent to the incorrect PayPal account!
    - Clicking on the blue text below the summary that says “Add your PayPal email address...” will take you to your Profile page (also reachable by clicking on your name in the top right corner),

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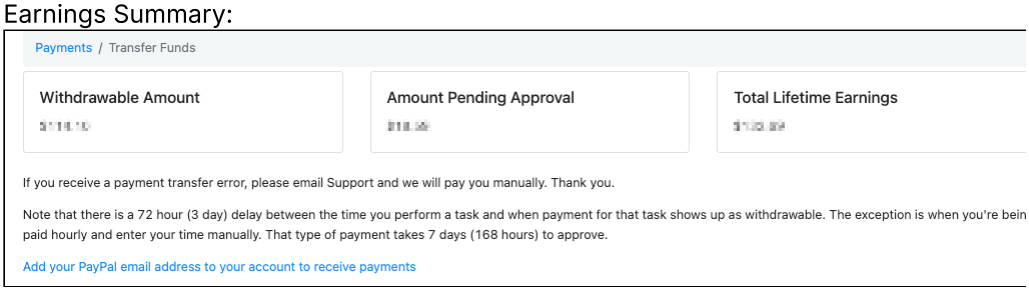
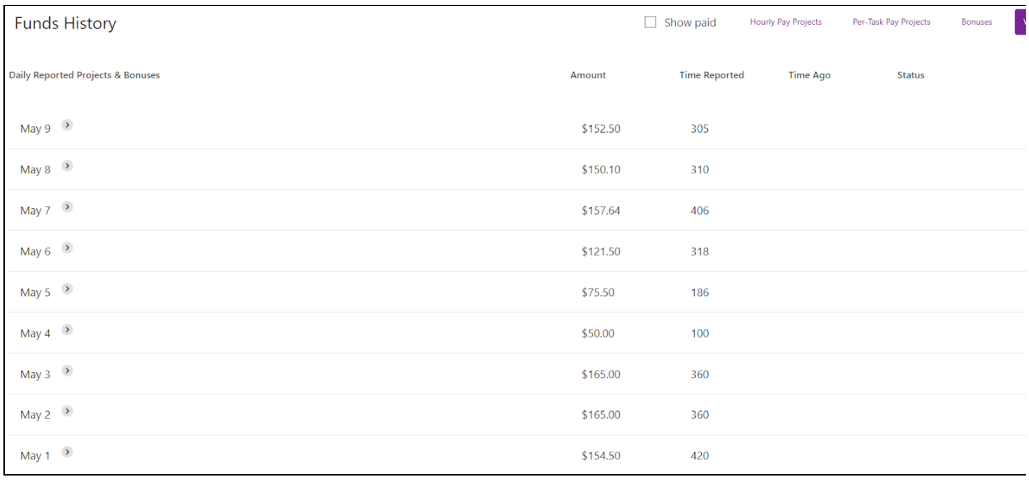
task projects; payment will be approved 72 hours after you complete the task
    - 7-day approval period for hourly projects; payment will be approved 168 hours after you report your time
- Total Lifetime Earnings: this is the total amount you've earned on the platform since you started
    - Includes "Withdrawable Amount," "Amount Pending Approval," and funds previously withdrawn

Earnings Summary:



Funds History

This section lists any date that you submitted a task (either individually-paid or for an hourly project) or a time entry. You can expand the date and project's name to see all of your task submissions and time entries. Clicking "Show paid" will reveal any tasks/time entries for which funds have already been transferred to PayPal.



Daily Reported Projects & Bonuses

This section shows a breakdown of the hourly work entries you have submitted, along with

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- **Paid**: this payment has been approved and paid out to your PayPal account upon your request

Daily Reported Projects & Bonuses	Amount	Time Reported	Time Ago	Status
May 9	$67.82	197		
Antimony - Turn-By-Turn Factuality Evaluation - With Search Results! (ID: V-18225)	$16.34	49		
Task Submission	$0.00		1 minute ago	
Task Submission	$0.00		4 minutes ago	
Task Submission	$0.00		5 hours ago	
Task Submission	$0.00		6 hours ago	
Time Entry	$9.34	28	29 seconds ago	Pending App

“Inbox” Page

The Inbox is one of the main ways DataAnnotation will communicate with you about opportunities on the platform. If you see a number next to the word “Inbox”, it shows how many unread messages you have (note the X unread messages in the screenshot below). If you don’t see a number, then you have no unread messages.

When you click on “Inbox,” you will see all of your messages, including general announcements and updates about new or active projects or bonus opportunities. These are typically messages that go out to large groups of annotators.

You may also receive direct communication from the DataAnnotation admin team to communicate personalized project or task-specific feedback. Also, if you message the Admin team directly, their responses will appear in this section.

You will receive an email notification whenever you have a new message in your DataAnnotation Inbox. While you can change this setting on the “Profile” page, we recommend keeping it enabled to avoid missing important updates.

When you click on a message, it will open up that thread. From there, you can click on any hyperlinks included in the message.

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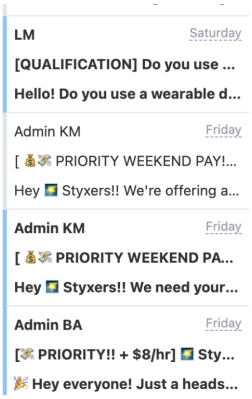

“Profile” Page

Your “Profile” page is a place where you can access, add, or update your personal information, including languages you can speak, your worker account details, and your payment information. You can also identify some of your skills and expertise, as well as update various information associated with your account.

1. **Languages**: If you can speak multiple languages, you can use this section to indicate your fluency and add new languages to your account. This may give you access to more work, as we run projects in many different languages. Please refer to our fluency scale when selecting from the “How well do you speak this language?” dropdown.
2. **Skills**: In this section, you can add additional details about yourself that will help us understand the projects for which you are the best fit, including your educational background, hobbies, and professional experience.
3. **Profile (Personal Information)**: Your worker ID is auto-generated, and can be used to reference your account when communicating with admins or Support. Your referral code can be given to others and entered into their Starter Assessment after signing up. Your email address can be changed at any time.
4. **Email Notifications Enabled?**: Uncheck this box if you would not like to receive email notifications from DataAnnotation (*not recommended*)

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PayPal with, and it should be formatted as "email@example.com", not a PayPal.me URL.

b. **Double check that you have entered the correct PayPal email address**, as you will not be able to change it once entered.

6. **Delete My Account**: Click this link to delete your account. You will be asked to re-enter your email on the next screen to confirm the deletion.

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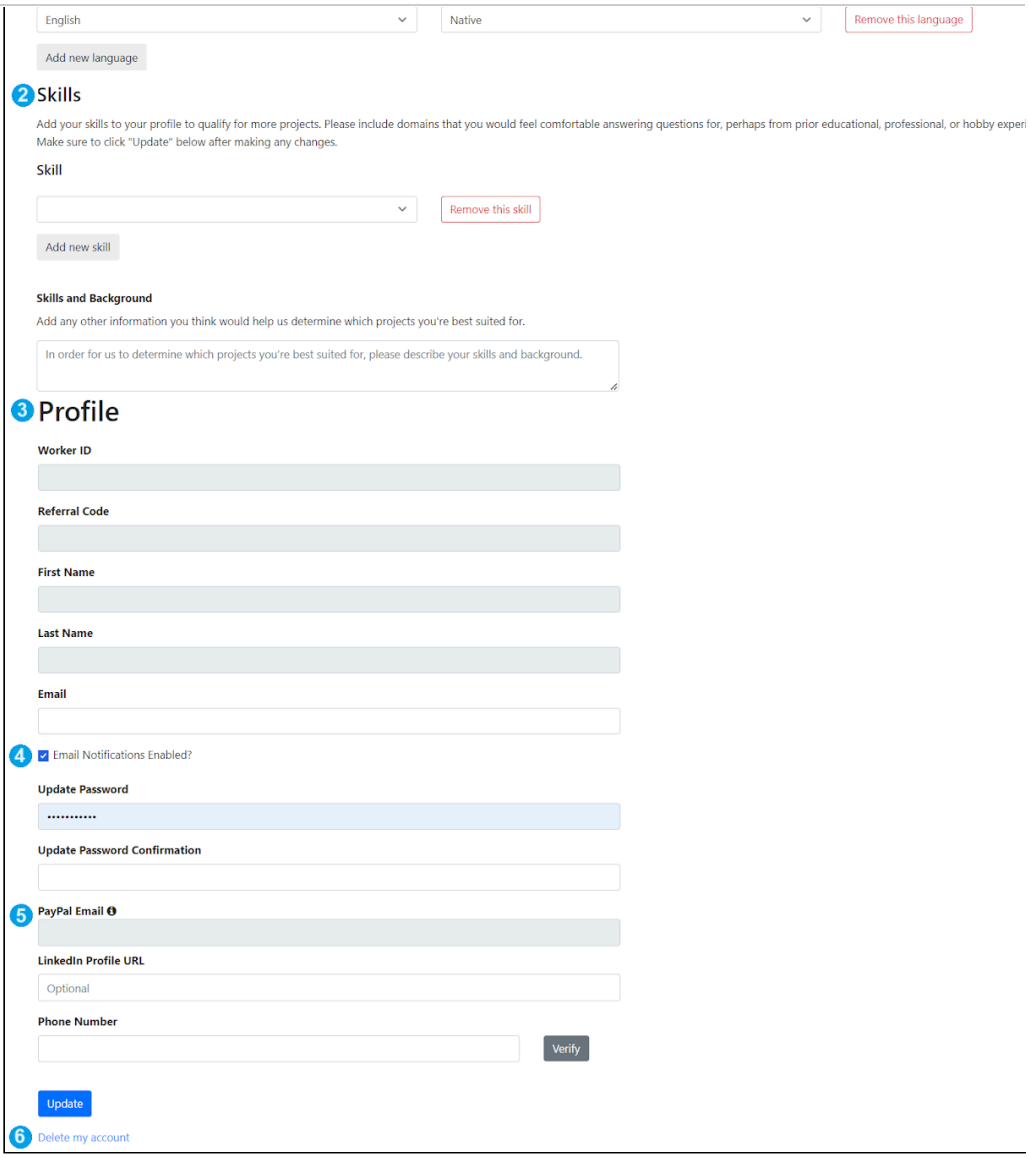

Project Workflow

Now that we've gone through the structure of our site, let's dive into what your interface will look like while working on projects!

Interface

1. A blue "Submit" button will appear in the bottom left-hand corner — click this button when you have completed a task and are ready to progress to the next.

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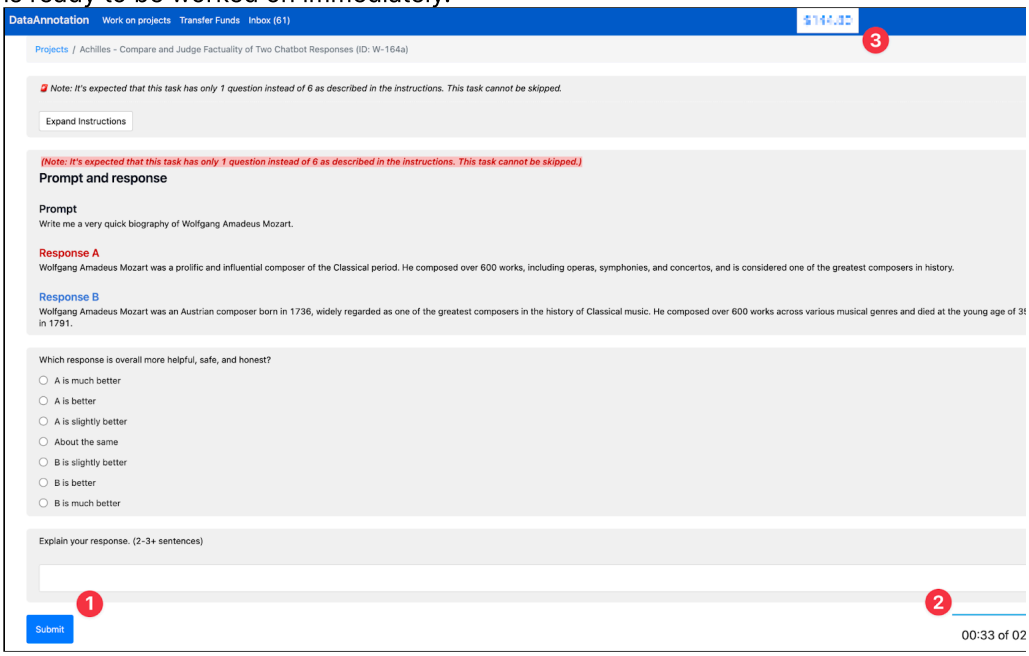
released for someone else to work on, so be sure to finish and submit your work before that happens.

   b. The timer is NOT intended for timekeeping. If you're working on an hourly project, you'll need to manually track how long you spend. Some workers use a stopwatch app, while others prefer to use an app or browser tool (such as Clockify) to keep track of their hours.

3. The white box in the upper right hand corner (blurred in the image below) shows the amount of money you have earned since your last withdrawal including funds that are available for withdrawal and funds that are still pending approval.
   a. For per-task projects, this number will increase incrementally with each task you complete.
   b. For hourly projects, your pay will not be reflected in this field until you have reported your time.

Note: on some projects, there will be an "Enter Work Mode" button. You'll have to press this first before being able to interact and make selections on the task. If you don't see that button, you can ignore that process — the task is ready to be worked on immediately.



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fairly well, which is loosely as follows:

- Project Overview / Instructions: the first text box typically provides a general overview and outlines the objective of the project. Some projects will provide all task-specific instructions here, while others will link to external documentation. Links to examples are also often included here. It's also not uncommon for this box to contain important callouts, clarifications, or rules of thumb about a project for easy reference.
- After the overview, you'll typically see the specific data you're being asked to evaluate. In the screenshot above, the task is to compare two model responses to the same prompt: "Write me a very quick biography of Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart."
- Next, you'll select your answer — often one or more multiple-choice responses, and may be asked to provide a brief explanation as to why you made the selection(s) you did. The multiple-choice answers are generally required to help prevent accidental incomplete submissions.
- Below this is a field for Optional Comments about the task or project. Like the heading suggests, writing content here is optional, but we encourage annotators to use this field to flag tasks that are especially borderline or unusual/ambiguous in some way.

Generally speaking, most tasks/projects will follow a loose variation of this flow (Instructions — Piece of Data to Evaluate — Your Answer — Optional Comments — Submit). Depending on the complexity of a project, working on tasks may involve work besides selecting a multiple choice option or typing in an answer. For example, several of our projects employ a tagging tool in which you need to highlight particular portions of a body of text, and so on. Regardless of the project, we do our best to make the process as clear as possible. However, we understand that things may still be confusing, so please feel free to ask questions in the chat function (explained below) liberally.

Upon submitting a task, you will automatically be directed to the next task in the project, and this will continue until there are no more tasks available for you to work on in the project. Whenever you are done working for a period of time or would like to take a break from a project, please click the "Exit Work Mode"

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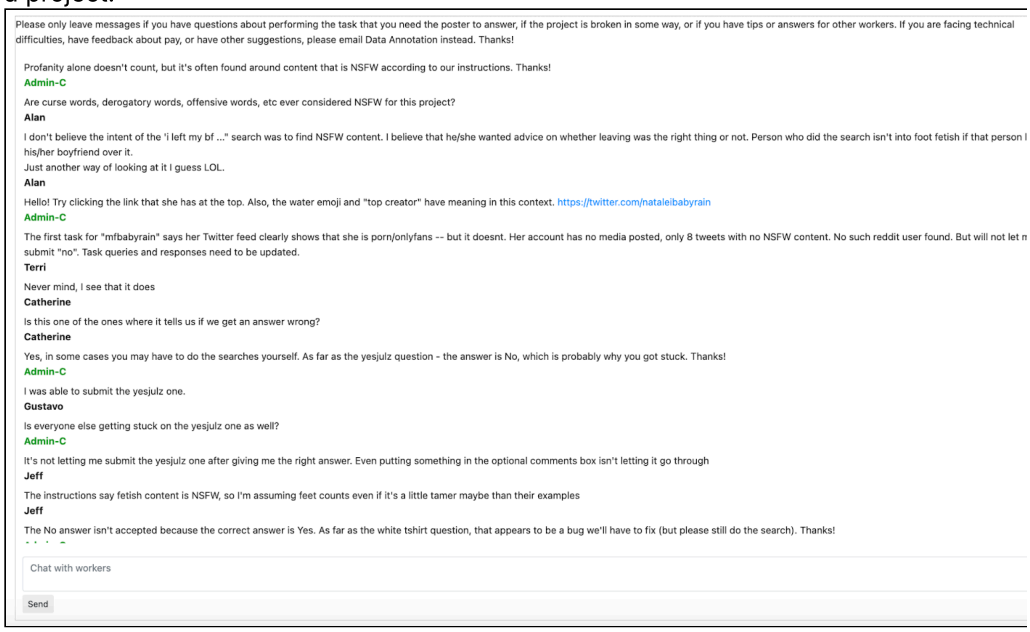
The chat function can be found below the task and “Submit” button. If no one has sent a message yet, “No messages yet” will be displayed in blue text. Clicking this text will open up a chat box where you can message the project admins and other annotators working on the project.

Here’s an example of a project chat. As you can see, the project admins are available to answer any questions you may have while working on a project.



As the instructions atop the chat indicate, the main purpose of this chat is to ask members of the Admin team questions about edge cases in the data. If you run into task-specific issues, feel free to ask them in the chat. If you have other general questions or technical difficulties on the platform, please submit a Support request instead (via the dropdown menu in the top right corner of the platform).

For simple inquiries, you are welcome to answer each other’s questions—for example, if a fellow worker asks a simple question about an edge case that is addressed in the

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periodically for any updates or clarifications that might get communicated there.

“Skip” and “Exit Work Mode”

Beneath the chat area you will find the “Skip” and “Exit Work Mode” buttons. The “Skip” button is helpful if you come across a task that is broken or that you don’t fully understand or want to answer.

Once your task is submitted (using the Submit button), you can use the Exit Work Mode button at the bottom left of the page to end your session and free up the next task for other annotators to work on. Or, if you decide not to work on a particular project, you can use this button to release the current task so someone else can try it. Just note that once you exit or release the task, you may not be able to return to it.

Project Instruction Updates

Projects can change and evolve over time, and when such changes occur, the project instructions will be updated. It’s important to keep an eye out for these updates so that you continue to work on the task correctly. The updates are usually highlighted, with the latest at the top. The updates are also typically dated, so there’s less confusion. You may also receive project updates as messages in your inbox (and in your email if you have notifications enabled).

In some cases, the updates will be made directly in the project interface. These will typically include guidance for commonly reported issues, answers to frequently asked questions, and specific areas of emphasis for the project moving forward. Please be diligent in reviewing these updates and make sure you understand them before moving forward.

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- Please no longer preface your answers with an index like A. B. C. D., 1. 2. 3. 4., Wrong Answer 1 Wrong Answer 2 and so on. We will randomizing the questions before having workers attempt to answer them, so we have to remove these if they are present in subm questions. Thank you!

Project Updates (3/2/23):

- When developing answers to your questions, please make the answers similar in length/detail. We have seen some correct answers twice as detailed/long as incorrect answers, which can give away an answer as being the right one.

In other instances, external documentation may get updated (shown below), or additional external links may get added. Please be sure to review any document updates before continuing to work on a project.

Instructions (see the Conversational Dialogues section)
FAQ AND COMMON MISTAKES **[UPDATED: 3/13]**

Bonuses

Occasionally, projects may be eligible for bonuses based on workload targets. As in the example below, the title of a project typically indicates when a bonus is available.

Teaching AI - Bonus Goals for 1/31 - 2/7	6	Jan 31

When you open up this bonus notification task, the instructions will explain how you can earn the bonus. Bonus instructions typically include the following details:

- The project(s) that are eligible for the bonus
- How many hours you must work or tasks you must complete to earn the bonus
- How much the bonus pays out
- How long the bonus is available
- The number of times you can earn the bonus
- Notes or special instructions you must follow to earn the bonus

Please read the bonus instructions carefully — it is important you follow the prescribed process for your work to qualify.

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Tips

Getting Access to More Projects

Completing **Qualifications** is the best (and sometimes only) way to gain access to new projects and more work. If you are able to complete them soon after they are posted, you may have a better chance of working on the project before the available tasks have been completed. Of course, the more projects you have access to, the busier you can be!

In general, a good rule of thumb for gaining access to additional projects and qualifications is to work on the projects you currently have! Once you show that you are a reliable worker, you may see more and more projects available to you.

Having email notifications enabled is a very helpful feature to ensure that you see new projects as soon as they become available.

What Projects Should I Work On?

It may be hard to decide on which projects to work on and how to spend your time. One method is to focus your work towards projects with a priority indication as shown below.

Teaching AI to be More Honest [v2] - Flagging Lies [mid priority]	$27.50/hr	68	Aug 30

Teaching AI to be More Helpful (with explanations) [high priority: increased pay]	$33.00/hr	48	Dec 02

Working on higher-priority projects is very helpful, but don't feel like you need to focus on them exclusively. Spending all your time on one project can be mentally taxing, so it's completely understandable to take a break and switch to a different one.

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earlier, it can be advantageous to split your time between different projects so that you don't get burnt out.

If you have access to projects with bonus goals, a great way to maximize your earnings is to meet those goals. You will find that your hourly rate increases significantly if you take the bonus payment into account.

Examples of Workflows

An example of someone structuring their workday may look like the following:

1) Determine how many hours they have available. Let's say they have 3 hours for this example.
2) Looking through their projects page, they see a new Qualification, a few hourly paid projects and a few per-task paid projects.
3) They are very familiar with one of the per-task paid projects and know the tasks typically get completed very quickly. They do these first so that they get a chance to work on them. They end up spending 30 minutes on these tasks before they run out.
4) Now, they'll complete the Qualification tasks. This also takes them 30 minutes.
5) They now have 2 hours left, so they dedicate their remaining time to the hourly paid project. (Note that they only work on one hourly project at a time!)

This is a good example of someone organizing their workflow to take advantage of the time they have available to access new projects, diversify their work, and optimize their wages.

Here's another example:

1) Determine how many hours they have available. This person has more time, with 5 hours available.
2) They also see a Qualification project, a per-task paid project (one they really enjoy, but doesn't pay as well) and a few hourly paid projects.
3) They have been working towards a bonus goal for an hourly paid project, so they start out by putting an hour of work towards that.
4) Now, they go ahead and complete the Qualification tasks. This takes them 30 minutes.
5) They go back to their hourly paid project and spend 2 hours working.
6) A mental break from the hourly paid project feels welcome and they see the

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priority of maximizing your wages, but also make a longer work session feel sustainable.

Support

If you have any questions about particular facets of our platform that were not answered in this document, you can get in touch with the DataAnnotation Support team by submitting a request (via the dropdown menu in the top right corner of the platform). As a reminder, DataAnnotation will never ask you for your email, password, or identity information via direct message on social media sites.